

10. Pay all bills at the same time

It often just takes a simple call to get a vendor or creditor to change the due date on your bills. If you can get all your bills to be due on, let's say, the 10th of the month, you can do all your bill paying at once. For some people, this will mean they will need to do a bit of scrimping to get ahead enough so that they can afford to make all their month's payments at the beginning of the month, but it's worth it. You can pay all your bills and be done with it. For more ways to simplify your life, check out my book, *The Power of Less*, or visit www.ZenHabits.net. — **Leo Babauta**

6 Tips for Following a Budget without Breaking Down in Tears

Budgeting can be difficult. For some people (like me!), it brings up things

that they may not want to see. For others, it's a necessary but frustrating tool to curtail spending, or a painful reminder of how much they overspent, yet again.

But there are a few people who live well on a budget. These few manage to record their spending and yet aren't overwhelmed by that. They see where they spend too much and yet don't give up the budget. Month after month they take the time to collect their receipts, enter them, and evaluate based on the results. They aren't overwhelmed or discouraged, and they don't give up. Instead, they plug away at it until they get their spending under control, and then they often keep at it to have a record of where their money goes. Slowly, slowly, I'm becoming one of them, and here is what I've learned along the way.

1. Give yourself some space

Your budget is not going to work perfectly from the beginning, unless you're a financial genius. It's just not. Gas will cost more than you expected, or your phone will get stolen and the company will charge you for the extra minutes, throwing off your careful planning. Things happen. Life happens. Particularly in the early stages of budgeting, where you're working with unsure numbers. You'll get better at